

CARDBOARD PC CASE (₹250)



A time consuming DIY project that will require some time to perfect. The most expensive material can be skipped, which will leave you with a total cost of just ₹50, and you have a custom Pc case like no other!

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MATERIALS NEEDED

- Cardboard box - Free
- 30x cable zip ties: ₹40 (packet of 100)
- 1x acrylic sheet: ~₹200
- 1x power button: ₹10

This particular DIY will have an enormous scope for improvement after you've completed the project. The easiest approach would be to either use a shoebox or any cardboard box big enough to accommodate all the components. For most of the other materials, we were able to salvage parts from old cabinets biting dust at our labs. We've listed down the alternatives to buy if you don't have them. You also need to ensure that you have all the basic components to build the PC. They include the motherboard, CPU, CPU cooler, graphics card, memory sticks, storage drive and PSU. If you plan on using it daily, then we would recommend installing an exhaust fan like we did. We are going with a mini-ITX motherboard build for this one. However, it's capable of supporting a full ATX motherboard.



STEP 01 Arrange your components inside the box to figure out the layout of your build. You have to judge yourself the best location for each component using trial and error. For example, place your motherboard first and install the GPU. Find out the corner where you want the I/O ports. The same goes for the PSU. Another outlet will be required for the exhaust fan pulling out all the hot air from inside. You also need to decide where you will access the internals from. You can cut out the side, but that would affect the structural integrity of the box. Hence, we went with a foldable top. There cannot be a single template for the internal layout.



STEP 02 Once you've decided the layout, trace out the portions and cut them. Do note that you need to maintain enough clearance from the top panel and the motherboard for fans. Cut conservatively, because if you make a mistake you can cut some more later, but if you cut too much, that's another cardboard box ruined! Place the components again to verify whether the cutting was done as required.



STEP 03 The transparent window on the side is optional. You need to decide how big you want your window. Our size was dependent on a sheet we found in an old cabinet. You can buy an acrylic sheet for your build. Cut out the required area and stick the sheet from the inside with a glue gun.



STEP 04 It's time to start installing the main components and we'll install the PSU first. The heaviest of all the components, it should go at the bottom. Otherwise, you'll have to build a strong platform to hold it at the top. Without any screws, you can push holes around the PSU to secure it with cable zip ties. If you don't have long zip ties, you can chain them together just like we did.